

Five candidate areas, two worth building on: express the clue, and recover after a miss

Each area is a predicate over the coded records, so frequency and severity are computed, not asserted. Areas overlap by design: one record can carry several problems.

THE FIVE CANDIDATE AREAS, MEASURED

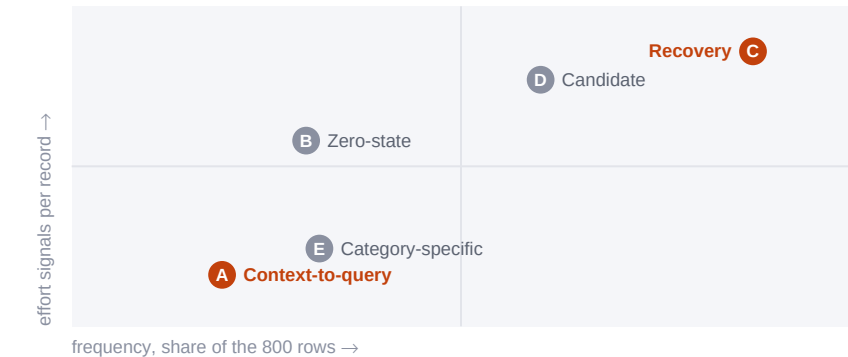
Area	Definition over the coded records	Records	Ends badly	2+ signals
A Context-to-query translation	Record states it cannot turn the memory into a keyword	322 (40%)	39%	65%
B Zero-state after a vague query	Record ends on the exit path: failed, gave up or left	341 (43%)	100%	74%
C Recovery guidance after a miss	Recovery-dependent, or shows switching, retrying or rephrasing	442 (55%)	30%	79%
D Candidate filtering and review	Inspecting candidates, browsing, or an unmanageable result set	394 (49%)	24%	77%
E Category-specific retrieval	Object is a person or a document: the two hardest classes	344 (43%)	40%	67%

“Ends badly” = failed, gave up, or left for another app (42.6% across all 800 rows). “2+ signals” = two or more effort signals in one record (63.8% overall). Area B is defined by its outcome, so its 100% cannot count as evidence of severity.

WHAT WOULD CHANGE THIS RANKING

- If matching is the real failure — the corpus cannot see it: only 120 rows describe what came back, so D3 stays untested until the task tests run.
- If severity is an artefact — effort signals come from people who chose to post. A quick-success contrast group in the interviews is the check.
- If the overlap hides a single cause — A and C may be one problem seen twice. The first-failing-node classification decides that, not this table.

FREQUENCY AGAINST SEVERITY



THE CALL

- Build on A and C**
They sit upstream: A decides what the product ever gets to search on, C decides whether a miss is recoverable. Together they cover 572 of 800 rows (72%).
- D follows, not leads**
Filtering only matters once a query returns the right candidates; 77% carry two or more effort signals, so it is a strong second wave.
- B is a symptom**
Its 100% bad outcome is definitional. It measures where attempts die, not why.
- E is a slice**
Person and document photos are hardest, but the failure inside them is still A and C.

SCOPE THIS SETS

A or C covers 572 of 800 rows (72%), of which 192 carry both problems at once. 228 rows sit outside both: mostly single first attempts, and records that state an outcome without a behaviour. Slide 5 narrows this to the segment the research will watch.